

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Carbon monoxide

HOME BUILDING / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

If a CO alarm sounds or carbon monoxide exposure is suspected, get everyone into fresh air immediately and call emergency services. Do not stay inside to find the source. Headache, dizziness, nausea or confusion can be warning signs.

Do now.

☐**Leave the building**

01

Move people and pets into fresh air, without delaying to ventilate or troubleshoot.

☐**Call from outside**

02

Report the alarm, symptoms and possible fuel-burning source to emergency services.

☐**Get medical help**

03

Tell responders about suspected exposure even if symptoms improve outdoors.

☐**Wait for clearance**

04

Do not reenter until responders say it is safe.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Leave the building even if responders cannot be reached. Gather outside away from exhaust, keep everyone out and seek reachable medical care for symptoms. Do not send someone back inside to ventilate or switch equipment off.

Watch for.

CO is invisible and odorless. A silent smoke alarm is not proof that air is safe.

People & practical needs.

Children, sleeping people and people with limited mobility may not recognize symptoms or reach fresh air independently. Assign evacuation help in advance and keep functioning CO alarms near sleeping areas

Next decision.

Install CO alarms and service heating equipment. Keep generators and grills outdoors, far from openings.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Carbon monoxide · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/carbon-monoxide/>